SkillNavora

MODULE 11 HANDBOOK

Module 11: Customer-Facing Engineering, Consulting and Communication

5 sections, every topic explained with how it works, examples and resources.

From Non-Coder to Enterprise AI Builder: Learn, Build, Deploy, Get Hired and Launch Your AI Business.

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Financial figures are hypothetical examples, not advice.

Module 11: Customer-Facing Engineering, Consulting and Communication

Every section below explains the concept, how it works, each listed topic in detail, a worked example and where to learn more.

Sections

1. 11.1 Customer Discovery
2. 11.2 Stakeholder Management
3. 11.3 Technical Communication
4. 11.4 Delivery and Deployment Management
5. 11.5 Production Support

MODULE 11 · SECTION 11.1

11.1 Customer Discovery

DEFINITION

> Customer discovery for an FDE gathers business goals, process details and technical constraints directly from the client before designing anything.

HOW IT WORKS

- Meet business owners for goals and pain; meet users to watch the process; meet IT for systems, data access and security rules.
- Capture requirements as goals, users, inputs, outputs, volumes, systems, constraints and success metrics.
- Validate feasibility early with a small data sample or a one-day spike.

EVERY TOPIC EXPLAINED

Client discovery meetings; business and technical requirement gathering. Client discovery meetings learn the client's goals, current process, pain points, systems and constraints. Business requirements describe what outcome is needed; technical requirements describe systems, data, security, performance and integration needs.

Stakeholder interviews; business process observation; problem validation; technical feasibility. Stakeholder interviews collect each group's view (leaders, users, IT, security, finance). Business process observation watches the real work, which often differs from the documented process. Problem validation confirms the problem is real, frequent and costly. Technical feasibility checks access to data and systems, model capability and constraints early.

WORKED EXAMPLE

> Discovery questions: How many documents a day? What happens when one is wrong? Who approves? Where does the data live? Can it leave your network?

RESOURCES

- Y Combinator: how to talk to users https://www.ycombinator.com/library/6g-how-to-talk-to-users

- The Mom Test (book site) https://www.momtestbook.com/

11.2 Stakeholder Management

DEFINITION

> Stakeholder management keeps each person who can help or block the project informed, involved and aligned.

HOW IT WORKS

- Map stakeholders by influence and interest; CTO and CISO care about architecture and security, CFO about cost and ROI, operations about daily workflow.
- Set expectations in writing: scope, timeline, what AI can and cannot do, and accuracy targets.
- When people disagree, return to the agreed goal and data; escalate early, not late.

EVERY TOPIC EXPLAINED

Working with CTOs, CIOs, CFOs, CISOs and business teams. CTOs care about architecture fit and maintainability; CIOs about systems and portfolio; CFOs about cost and ROI; CISOs about security, privacy and risk; business teams about daily workflow and results. Tailor each conversation to what that person is accountable for.

Managing expectations, resolving disagreements, communicating technical constraints. Manage expectations by stating what AI can and cannot do, accuracy targets and timelines in writing. Resolve disagreements by returning to shared goals and evidence. Communicate technical constraints (rate limits, data access, accuracy limits) early, with options and trade-offs rather than only problems.

WORKED EXAMPLE

> The CISO blocks a cloud model; you propose a private deployment option with a cost comparison, and the steering group chooses.

RESOURCES

- PMI: stakeholder management https://www.pmi.org/learning/library/stakeholder-management-task-project-success-7736
- Atlassian: stakeholder map https://www.atlassian.com/team-playbook/plays/stakeholder-communications

11.3 Technical Communication

DEFINITION

> Technical communication explains systems, decisions and results clearly to both engineers and executives.

HOW IT WORKS

- Executives get the outcome, cost, risk and decision needed, on one page.
- Engineers get the architecture diagram, data flows, interfaces and runbooks.
- Demos show a real workflow end to end; proof-of-concept results report accuracy on the client's own data.

EVERY TOPIC EXPLAINED

Technical presentations, architecture walkthroughs, product demonstrations. Technical presentations explain a solution's design and reasoning. Architecture walkthroughs take reviewers through diagrams, data flows and decisions. Product demonstrations show the solution working on realistic scenarios.

Proof-of-concept presentations, technical workshops, code-with sessions. Proof-of-concept presentations report what was tested, results on the client's data and next steps. Technical workshops teach or co-design with client teams. Code-with sessions pair FDEs with client engineers to build together and transfer skills.

Technical documentation, executive summaries, business impact presentations. Technical documentation: architecture, setup, APIs, runbooks. Executive summaries: one page with problem, result, cost, risk and decision. Business impact presentations connect results to the client's KPIs and money.

WORKED EXAMPLE

> Executive summary: 'The pilot extracted 1,200 invoices at 96% field accuracy, saving an estimated 40 hours a week. Decision needed: approve production rollout.'

RESOURCES

- Google: technical writing courses https://developers.google.com/tech-writing
- C4 model for architecture diagrams https://c4model.com/

11.4 Delivery and Deployment Management

DEFINITION

> Delivery management plans and runs the project from scope to production release and handover.

HOW IT WORKS

- Define scope and milestones; keep a risk log with owners and mitigations.
- User acceptance testing (UAT): the client tests against agreed criteria before go-live.
- Production readiness checklist: monitoring, alerts, backups, runbooks, security sign-off, support contacts.
- Handover includes documentation, training and knowledge transfer.

EVERY TOPIC EXPLAINED

Project planning, scope management, risk management. Project planning sets milestones, owners and dates. Scope management controls what is in and out, with a change process. Risk management lists risks, likelihood, impact, owner and mitigation.

Testing, UAT, production readiness, release management, deployment documentation. Testing covers unit, integration, performance and AI evaluation. User acceptance testing (UAT): the client verifies the solution meets agreed criteria. Production readiness: monitoring, security, backups, support and runbooks are in place. Release management schedules and controls go-live. Deployment documentation records how to deploy and roll back.

Knowledge transfer, client training, change management. Knowledge transfer hands over understanding to the client's team. Client training teaches users and admins. Change management helps people adopt the new process.

WORKED EXAMPLE

> Go-live checklist: UAT signed, evaluation set passed, on-call rota set, rollback tested, users trained.

RESOURCES

- Atlassian: project management https://www.atlassian.com/project-management
- Google SRE: launch checklist https://sre.google/sre-book/reliable-product-launches/

11.5 Production Support

DEFINITION

> Production support keeps the deployed solution working and improving after launch.

HOW IT WORKS

- Monitor dashboards and alerts; triage incidents by severity; communicate status to the customer.
- Root-cause analysis finds why it failed; fixes are tested and released; post-deployment reviews capture lessons.
- Add every real failure case to the evaluation set so it cannot return silently.

EVERY TOPIC EXPLAINED

Production troubleshooting, incident management, root cause analysis. Production troubleshooting finds why something fails in the live system using logs, metrics and traces. Incident management: detect, classify severity, assign, communicate, resolve. Root cause analysis finds the underlying cause and prevents recurrence.

Monitoring, escalation, bug resolution, performance optimisation. Monitoring watches health, quality and cost dashboards. Escalation brings in the right expert or vendor when needed. Bug resolution reproduces, fixes, tests and releases. Performance optimisation improves speed and cost (caching, smaller models, better queries).

Post-deployment reviews and continuous improvement. Post-deployment reviews compare results with goals after launch. Continuous improvement uses feedback, failures and new requirements to plan the next iteration.

WORKED EXAMPLE

> An extraction error rate spikes after a supplier changes its invoice layout; the case is added to tests, the prompt is updated, and accuracy recovers.

RESOURCES

- PagerDuty incident response guide https://response.pagerduty.com/
- Google SRE book: postmortem culture https://sre.google/sre-book/postmortem-culture/